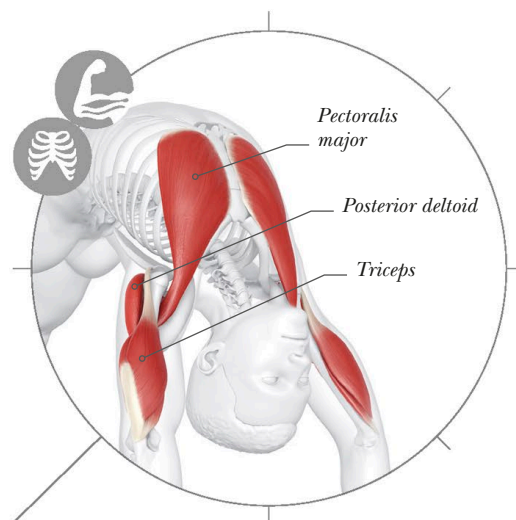
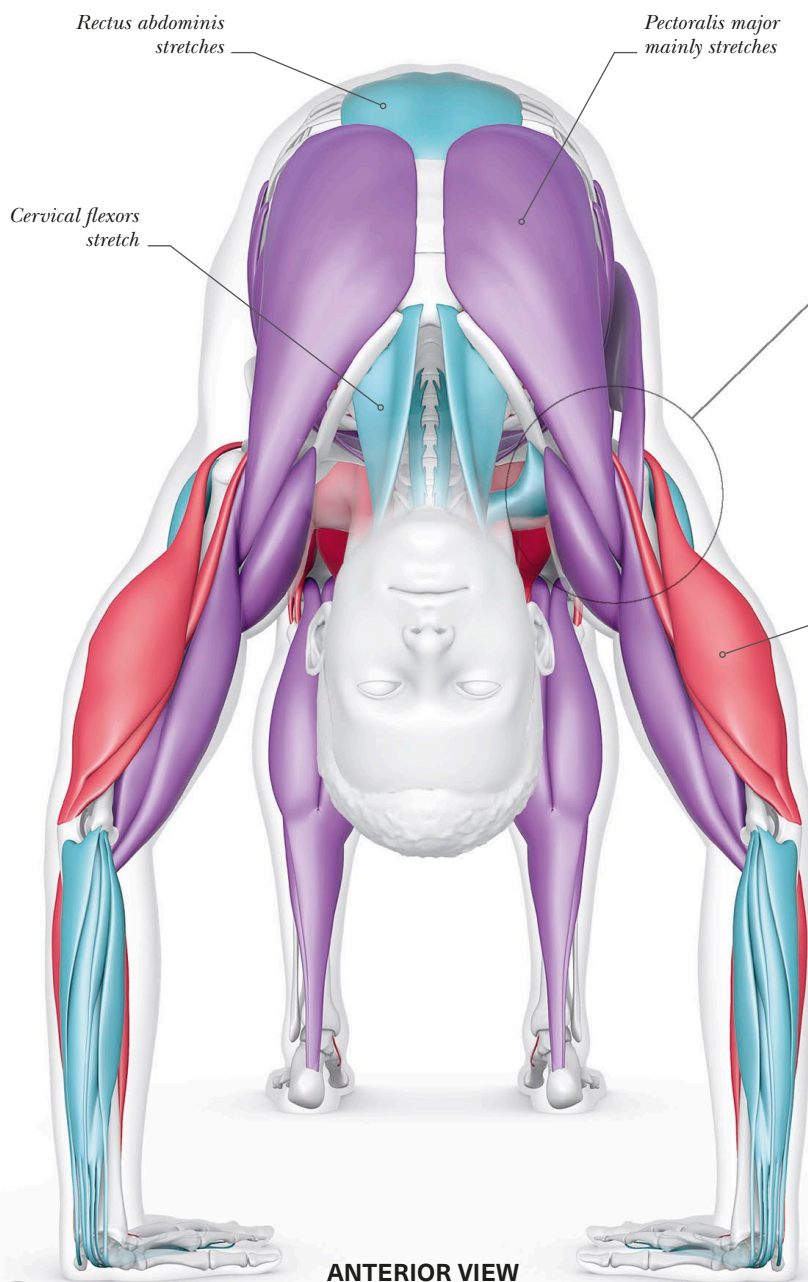


» CLOSER LOOK

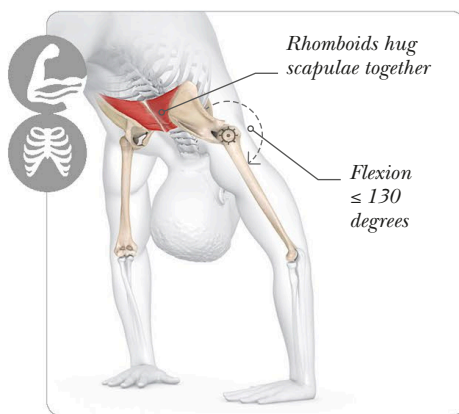
Wheel puts your shoulder joints and spine in a unique position that can be challenging both for people who are tight and those who are very flexible. It can be quite demanding, yet energizing and uplifting.



Tight shoulders

Tight shoulders are a common limiting factor for this pose. Many people lack the range of motion to go into full shoulder flexion, bringing the arms directly overhead. Make sure you thoroughly warm up your shoulders before doing Wheel. Stretch your shoulders over time with poses like Cow Face (see pp.60–63).

Triceps engage to extend elbows, but may stretch too if tight



Shoulder flexion

In shoulder flexion there is little stability, particularly when weight bearing as in Wheel. If you are very flexible, especially with a tendency toward dislocation, be mindful when doing this pose, or try Bridge pose for a more stable shoulder position in extension instead (see pp.136–39).